



Hitting the bullseye: Ravi Malik was a member of the Haryana team that won the Indian round archery competition at the National Games in Dehradun. JONATHAN SELVARAJ

With steep learning curve for Indian bow, archers look to graduate to recurve

It might be a medal event at the National Games, but most Indian archers **can't wait** to move on from the Indian bow.

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By any measure, Manish Singh of Mathura, Uttar Pradesh, has had a successful National Games, securing a gold and a silver medal in the Indian bow archery competition. Thanks to his State's generous sports reward policy, he

can expect to earn approximately Rs 10 lakh — the Uttar Pradesh government has announced Rs 6 lakh for gold medal winners and Rs 4 lakh for silver.

Manish plans to use the money to pay off loans his father, a farmer, took to support his sporting career. Then, without hesitation, he intends

to abandon the equipment that brought him his most significant medals and invest upwards of Rs 3 lakh in a sleek, modern recurve bow, thus starting his career from scratch.

Although the Indian round is a medal event at the National Games, and some advocates vouch for its roots in indigenous tradition, for